Year 8 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `Y08/Y08_Student_Paper_v3.1`. Version 3.1 is version 2 with the third reading text (Part C) removed: the listening, writing, maths, science and interview are unchanged from version 2. The reading paper is now Parts A and B (16 marks) in the same time as before. Do not mix papers and instructions from different versions: the question numbers, marks and band guides differ.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y08_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

For students applying to join **Year 8** (age 12 to 13 on 1 September). A Year 8 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 6** (the end of primary school) and is the same age as a student starting Grade 7 (初一). The version 2 maths paper starts at the level expected on entry to Year 8 (the end of UK Year 7) and goes well beyond it, into Year 8 content, so expanding and factorising, equations with the unknown on both sides, inequalities, index laws, standard form, probability as a number and the mean from a frequency table **may not have been taught yet** (Section 4). A Year 8 entrant has usually done **no secondary science**: the science paper tests UK Year 7 content, so read the science score with the NT notes in Section 5. Background, the English bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Notes
1	Welcome	2	Assessor	Student paper, pencil, rubber, ruler	Script in Section 2
2	Listening (paper pages 2 to 5)	about 16 (recording)	Assessor plays the recording, or reads each script twice	These instructions, Section 3.1; the recording	Part A: a conversation with two voices. Part B: a short talk. Can be done with a small group
3	Reading paper (pages 6 to 9)	15	Student works alone; assessor times	Clock or timer	Do not read the texts aloud
4	Writing (pages 10 to 11)	10	Student works alone		Choose one of two tasks
5	Break	5		Water	
6	Maths (pages 12 to 17)	25	Student; assessor may read questions aloud	No calculator, no protractor	Section A Fluency, Section B Word questions, Section C Applied problems
7	Science (pages 18 to 20)	8	Student; assessor may read questions aloud		
8	Interview, opening with sentence reading	15	Interviewer, 1:1	Interviewer guide, Interview sheet, Reading front sheet, Sentence reading guide and card, a plain card	Sentence reading starts at **Level 7** (sentence 19)
	Total	**about 95**			Including the welcome and the break. Plus the parent conversation (about 15 minutes, separate)

Marks go on the **grading sheet** (listening, writing, maths and science), the **Reading front sheet** (reading) and the **Interview sheet** (speaking).

For each candidate:

- the Year 8 student paper, version 3.1 (20 pages, A4; print it double-sided, so that the listening Part B pages, 4 and 5, face each other);
- the grading sheet (`Y08/Y08_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 7 to 10 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; laminate it);
- the other equipment in the table above: a pencil, a rubber and a ruler for each candidate, a clock or timer, a plain card to cover the sentences, and water for the break.

Version 3.1 compared with version 1

Part	Version 1	Version 3.1
Listening	One conversation, 8 marks, 5 minutes	**Part A** is the version 1 conversation, unchanged (questions 1 to 8). **Part B** is new: a short academic talk (questions 9 to 16). 16 marks, about 12 minutes
Reading	Three texts, 24 marks, 12 minutes	**Part A** is version 1 Part A (the notice). **Part B** is version 1 Part C (the sleep article), renumbered 7 to 13. There is no Part C: the version 2 feature article above age level is not used. Two texts, 16 marks, 15 minutes
Maths	Number problems and word problems, 30 marks, 20 minutes	Aimed at the higher end, in three sections: **Fluency** (10 marks), **Word questions** (8) and **Applied problems** (12). 30 marks, 25 minutes, with three sub-scores
Writing, science, interview		Unchanged

2. Before you start

Welcome script. Say, in a calm, friendly voice:

> "Hello, I'm … . Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities in English: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and find the right support for you. Some questions are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Do your best, and it is OK if you cannot answer everything. In maths and science I can read a question to you. In the English parts I cannot explain words, because we want to see your English. You can always ask me to say an instruction again. Do you have any questions?"

Pace of speech. Many Year 8 students are still learning English: speak steadily, slightly slower than normal speech, about 160 words a minute, when you give instructions, read the listening scripts and read maths and science questions aloud. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way.

Access rules (the same in every year group; details in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 7)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate or read the reading texts aloud. You may repeat instructions in English.	Read any question aloud in English, as often as asked, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Mark the question **L** in the margin. The mark still counts.
Answers	**All answers must be in English** (numbers, ticks, drawings and working count). An answer in Chinese scores 0.	**All answers must be in English**, including the explanations in maths questions 14, 17b and 18. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0. Short phrases and numbers are enough.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics and L questions on the grading sheet.

- **Extra time or a reader** for a known need is allowed; record it on the grading sheet.
- **Stopping.** The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. **Listening:** if you are assessing one student who clearly understood very little of Part A (a student new to English, for example), you may leave out Part B: say "Thank you, that is fine," and record "Part B not given" on the grading sheet; the band then comes from Part A. With a group, read Part B to everyone and tell them it is hard. **Reading:** Part B is harder than Part A: if the student is clearly stuck, let them stop and say "Thank you, that is fine." **Writing:** if the student cannot write in English, ask them to write any words they know, or a plan; do not score Chinese writing, but keep it. Never push a distressed student: take a break or stop, and record it on the grading sheet.
- **Keeping the student at ease.** Explain the order of the morning and the break. Sit beside, not opposite, for the interview. Praise effort, not answers ("Thank you, you are working hard"). Do not show surprise at mistakes. Keep the timer out of the student's line of sight, and give a calm two-minute warning near the end of each timed part. Many Year 8 students have just left primary school: tell them that listening Part B, reading Part B and the end of each maths section are meant to be hard, that the science has topics they may not have studied yet, and that this is expected.

3. English

3.1 Listening (about 16 minutes with the recording, 16 marks)

There are two parts. **Part A** is the everyday conversation from version 1, unchanged. **Part B** is a short talk at the level of a lesson for a fluent student of 12 to 13.

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y08/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace, one reading of Part A takes about 2 minutes 17 seconds and of Part B about 2 minutes 56 seconds, with the pauses: use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script. Play Part A and Part B as separate tracks if you may stop after Part A; otherwise the full track plays both.

Part A: Mei and Amir talk about the charity fair (questions 1 to 8, about 5 minutes)

Say: "Turn to the Listening pages. There are two parts. In Part A, I am going to read a conversation between two students, Mei and Amir. I will read it two times. First, read questions 1 to 8." Give the student **one minute** to look at questions 1 to 8 (pages 2 and 3). Then say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

Read it twice at the steady pace in Section 2 (about 160 words a minute). You read both parts. Say the speaker's name before each turn, a little more quietly, and make the two voices slightly different. Pause for about 3 seconds at

each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give 30 seconds to finish. Do not repeat any part, and do not explain any word.

Script: Mei and Amir talk about the charity fair

Amir: Mei, have you decided what our class is going to sell at the charity fair?

Mei: Yes! We wanted to sell cakes, but the Year 9 classes are already doing that. So we're going to sell plants instead: small ones, in pots. **[pause]**

Amir: Plants? OK. When is the fair? Is it this Friday?

Mei: No, it's next Saturday, from ten in the morning until two in the afternoon. **[pause]**

Amir: And where is our stall? Next to the music stage again?

Mei: No. Last year it was so loud there that nobody could hear us. This year we're by the main gate. **[pause]**

Amir: What can I do to help?

Mei: Can you make the price signs? You're much better at drawing than me. And Ms Chen says every class needs its own table. Can you bring one?

Amir: Sure. I'll do the signs this weekend, and I'll ask my dad about a table. He's got a folding one at home. **[pause]**

Mei: Thank you!

Amir: Where will we get the plants?

Mei: My aunt has a flower shop. She'll give us forty plants for 200 yuan. **[pause]**

Amir: And how much will we sell them for?

Mei: Ten yuan each. If we sell all of them, we'll get 400 yuan. After we pay my aunt, there will be 200 yuan for the charity. **[pause]**

Amir: Great. Oh, but I can only come in the morning. I have a piano lesson at one o'clock. **[pause]**

Mei: That's fine. And I'm really happy about the main gate.

Amir: Me too. Everybody will walk past us when they come in!

Answers. One mark each. Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Answers must be in English.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**B** plants		A (cakes): heard "cakes" but missed "but the Year 9 classes are already doing that".
2	**C** 2:00		A (10:00) is the start; B (1:00) is Amir's piano lesson.
3	**B** (by the main gate)		A: last year's place, next to the music stage.
4	**Both** make the price signs **and** bring a table		One correct only, or three or more ticked: 0. "Buy the plants" (the aunt gives them) and "play the piano" (his lesson) are distractors.
5	**40**	forty	200 (the cost).
6	**200**	200 yuan, ¥200	400: heard the takings but not "after we pay my aunt".
7	He has a piano lesson at one o'clock (and the fair goes on until two).	He has a piano lesson; he has to go to piano.	"He is drawing the signs"; "He is busy" with no reason.
8	Everybody walks past the main gate when they come in, so more people will see the stall.	It is not next to the music stage, so it is quieter and people can hear them; more customers.	"Because it is near the gate" with no reason; "because it is big".

Part B: Dr Lin's talk about noise in cities (questions 9 to 16, about 7 minutes)

Say: "Now turn to Part B on page 4. I am going to read a short talk by a scientist, Dr Lin. She is talking to a class about noise in cities. I will read it two times. First, read questions 9 to 16. You have one minute." After one minute, say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

Read it twice at the steady pace in Section 2 (about 160 words a minute), as a teacher would give a short talk. Pause for about 2 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish. Do not repeat any part, do not explain any word, and do not answer questions about the talk. Practise the talk aloud once before the day. Say these words clearly: **decibels** (DESS-ih-bels), **adrenaline** (a-DREN-a-lin), **chronic** (KRON-ik), **Munich** (MYOO-nik).

About the talk (for the English team). 389 words in 25 sentences (average 15.6 words); 19% of the words are outside the 2000 most common English word forms (15% after simple ending rules, names left out; method as in `02_Listening_Evidence_Statement`, Section 6). Features: a process and a chain of cause and effect (questions 11 and 15), comparisons and contrasts (a fountain and a street; the old and new airports), numbers and a statistic, subject words explained in passing (decibels, hormones, chronic), a correction ("Actually, that's not quite right", question 10), an opinion that is implied, not stated (question 14), and discourse markers (as a result, however, whereas, on the other hand, interestingly). The facts are simplified but sound: decibels and loudness, the stress response, European traffic noise figures and the Munich airport study (children's reading and memory near the old and new airports, 1992 onwards).

Script: Dr Lin's talk about noise in cities

Good morning, everyone. I'm Dr Lin, and I study how cities affect people's health. Today I want to talk about something most of us hardly notice: noise. **[pause]**

We measure noise in decibels, a unit that tells us how loud a sound is. A quiet library is about forty decibels, a normal conversation is about sixty, and a busy road can reach eighty. People often say that ten more decibels make a sound ten times louder. Actually, that's not quite right. Ten more decibels means ten times more energy, but to our ears the sound only seems about twice as loud. **[pause]**

So why does noise matter for health? When a sudden sound reaches your ears, your brain treats it as a warning of danger, even while you are concentrating on something else. As a result, your body releases stress hormones such as adrenaline, which make your heart beat faster and raise your blood pressure. This reaction helped our ancestors escape from predators, but in a city it can happen hundreds of times a day. Noise that continues for months or years is called chronic noise, and doctors have linked it to heart disease. **[pause]**

Across Europe, one in five people live with traffic noise loud enough to harm their health. Noise affects learning, too: when Munich moved its airport in 1992, researchers tested children living near the old airport and the new one. Near the new airport, the children's reading and memory became worse, whereas near the old airport, which was now quiet, they improved. **[pause]**

Interestingly, loudness is not the whole story. A fountain can be almost as loud as a busy street. However, most people find the sound of running water relaxing, while traffic makes them tense. **[pause]**

So what can cities do? Electric cars are often presented as the answer. They are certainly quieter in slow traffic, but above about forty kilometres an hour, most noise comes from the tyres, not the engine. On the other hand, lower speed limits and quieter road surfaces help more than most people expect. **[pause]**

In one new park beside a motorway, the noise level is only slightly lower than before, but the designers added several fountains, and visitors say they feel calmer there. **[pause]**

So next time someone tells you that cities are simply noisy places, ask them: does it have to be that way?

Answers. One mark for each question; questions 12 and 13 are one mark each. Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Answers must be in English.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
9	Detail: a number	**60**	sixty; 60 decibels	40 (a quiet library) or 80 (a busy road): heard the list of numbers but not which sound each one belongs to.
10	Detail: a correction	**about twice as loud**		"about ten times as loud": heard "People often say ..." but missed the correction "Actually, that's not quite right". "A hundred times" is not said.
11	Process (sequence)	Your brain treats the sound as a warning of danger **2** · Your body releases stress hormones **3** · Your heart beats faster **4**		All three correct for the mark. Heart before hormones: heard the words but not the chain of cause and effect ("As a result ... which make your heart beat faster").
12	Note completion	**memory**	memories; any spelling that is clear (memery, memori)	"reading" (already in the notes); "learning" (said in the sentence before); "worse".

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
13	Note completion	**improved**	got better; became better; were better; went up	"got worse" (the new airport); "quiet" (the old airport became quiet, not the children's results); "the same".
14	Speaker's attitude (implied)	**She thinks they help, but other changes may help more.**		"the best way to make cities quieter": the view she reports ("often presented as the answer") but does not share. "noisier": misheard "most noise comes from the tyres".
15	Inference joining two parts of the talk	The park has fountains, and (as Dr Lin said earlier) most people find the sound of running water relaxing, while traffic makes them tense. So the park feels calmer even though it is almost as loud.	They hear water, which is relaxing; the sound of the fountains is nicer or calmer than traffic; the fountains are relaxing; the pleasant water sound covers the traffic	"Because it is quieter" (she says the level is only slightly lower); "because there are fountains" with no idea of the sound being relaxing or pleasant; "because of the trees" (not said).
16	Main purpose	**to show that noise harms health, and that cities do not have to be so noisy**		"how scientists measure sound" and "noise in different cities in Europe" are single details; "electric cars will solve the problem of noise" is the opposite of her view.

Band guide v2 (listening, / 16). Use the part scores, in this order:

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 2	**A**
Part A 3 to 4	**B**
Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	**C**
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	**D**
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	**E**

Part A places a student in bands A to C; Part B separates C, D and E. If Part B is well above what Part A suggests (for example Part A 5, Part B 6), look for a slip in Part A, use judgement, and compare with "listening in conversation" on the Interview sheet.

What to look for

- **Part A:** questions 1 to 4 each have a distractor that is mentioned in the conversation. Choosing the distractor every time shows a listener catching single words, not following the exchange: typical of band B. Question 6 needs the student to hear a correction ("after we pay my aunt"); questions 7 and 8 need inference across two turns.
- **Part B** is at the level of a lesson for a fluent student of 12 to 13. A fluent Year 8 listener usually scores 6 or more. Questions 10 and 14 test whether the student follows how the speaker positions an idea: a listener who catches single words chooses "ten times" and "the best way". Question 15 joins two parts of the talk, and question 16 the whole talk.
- **English barrier or something else?** A strong Part A with a weak Part B means the student copes with everyday English but not yet with academic English: plan support for subject language in lessons. This is different from a low Part A. If a student scores low in both but understood you well in conversation, note it on the Reading front sheet and compare with the interview.

3.2 Reading paper (15 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading pages. Read the texts and answer the questions. There are two parts. Part B is harder than Part A. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 15 minutes." Start the timer. Do not read the

texts or questions aloud, and do not explain words. You may repeat this instruction. Give a two-minute warning.

Mark scheme. Spelling and grammar are not marked in reading answers if the meaning is clear. Answers copied from the text are fine when they answer the question. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: Greenway Sports Centre (a notice; very accessible, with pictures; version 1 Part A, unchanged)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
1	8:00	8, 8 am, eight o'clock	7:00 (the weekday time)
2	15 yuan	15, ¥15	30
3	People aged 16 and over	16 and over; over 16; 16+; people who are 16 or older	"Adults" (not what the notice says); "students"
4	A 2 yuan coin	2 yuan; a coin	"A student card"
5	a False · b True · c False		1 mark for each correct row (3 marks)
6	30 yuan	30, ¥30, 15 + 15	15 (one ticket); 60 (adult price)

Part B: Sleep: why teenagers need more of it (non-fiction, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 12; version 1 Part C, renumbered: version 1 questions 14 to 20 are now 7 to 13)

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
7	Retrieval	8 to 10 hours	between eight and ten hours	13; "a lot"
8	Inference	Teenagers' bodies release melatonin (the chemical that makes us sleepy) later, up to two hours later.	Their body clock changes; the sleepy chemical comes later; blue light from phones tells the brain it is still daytime	"They are lazy"; "they have homework" with no link to feeling sleepy
9	Vocabulary in context	very tired		
10	Retrieval (2)	Go to bed at about the same time every day · Put your phone in another room an hour before bed		**1 mark for each correct tick.** Take off 1 mark for each wrong tick beyond two boxes (minimum 0).
11	Inference	During deep sleep, the brain sorts and stores what we have learnt.	Sleep helps the brain save or keep information; the brain organises learning while you sleep	"Because they are not tired" with no link to memory
12	Author's purpose	To make teenage readers feel understood (it is not their fault), so they want to read on.	To get the reader's attention; to speak directly to the reader; to surprise the reader; to show it is about biology, not being lazy	"Because teenagers are lazy"
13	Author's purpose	to explain a problem and give advice		

Band guide (version 3.1; use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 3	**A**
Part A 4 or more, Part B 0 to 2	**B**
Part B 3 to 5	**C**
Part B 6 to 8	**D** or **E** (see below)

D or E. Part B is the age-level text, so 6 or more shows at least a competent reader. Give **E** only when Part B is 7 or 8 **and** the sentence reading screen (meaning checks and fluency) and the writing also point to E. Version 3.1 has no text above age level, so the reading paper alone cannot confirm band E.

Record the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes on the **Reading front sheet**, and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- Part B (the sleep article) is age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 12.
- Weaker readers copy a sentence near the key word whether or not it answers the question.
- If a student did not finish Part B in 15 minutes, note it on the Reading front sheet: a slow but accurate reader is different from a student who reached Part B and could not follow it.
- Part B has subject vocabulary (melatonin, releases, developing, alert). Students from Chinese schools often know the science in Chinese; vocabulary, not the idea, is usually the barrier.
- **English barrier or reading difficulty?** If a student reads aloud fluently in the sentence reading screen but scores low here, the gap is vocabulary and comprehension, not decoding. If a student is slow and inaccurate in both, and also reads slowly in Chinese (ask the parents), note a possible reading difficulty on the Reading front sheet.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task and tick it. Plan in the box first. Then write. Try to write about 20 lines. You have 10 minutes." You may repeat the instruction. Do not explain the prompts.

The tasks

- **Task 1 (descriptive):** describe a busy place you know well, for example a train station at Spring Festival, a night market or a sports match.
- **Task 2 (persuasive):** a speech to the class persuading students to waste less food in the school canteen.

Marking. Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 are between the descriptions). Total / 16. Then give the band by **best fit** with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, using the total only as a check.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing in English, or isolated words; no link to the task.	A short response that follows the task; a list of things seen, or of reasons, with simple links ("and", "also"); little development; little paragraphing.	Well shaped for the age: the description builds a clear picture through the senses and has a focus (a moment, a mood); the speech has a clear position, two or three developed reasons with examples, a call to action and an awareness of the audience ("we", "you"); paragraphs.
Vocabulary	Single memorised words or copied words.	Everyday words used correctly; some repetition; gaps filled with simple words or Chinese.	A wide range, chosen for effect: precise nouns, verbs and adjectives in the description; persuasive language in the speech (rhetorical questions, "imagine", "surely", "every day we ..."); words for linking ideas.
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Simple sentences and some joined with "and", "but", "because"; frequent errors (verb tenses, plurals, articles, word order) but meaning is mostly clear.	Varied sentences, including complex ones and some for effect (a short sentence after a long one, a list of three); tenses controlled; errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Spelling makes most words hard to read; no punctuation.	Common words spelt correctly; longer words phonetically plausible; full stops and capital letters used, not always correctly.	Accurate spelling, including most longer words; sentence punctuation secure; commas in lists and after openings, question and exclamation marks, apostrophes mostly correct.

Rough guide to the total (best fit decides): 0 to 3 **A** · 4 to 7 **B** · 8 to 10 **C** · 11 to 13 **D** · 14 to 16 **E**.

Band E writing at Year 8. Comparable to a fluent writer of 12 or 13. In 10 minutes, usually 180 to 280 words in clear paragraphs. The description goes beyond a list: it uses the senses, chooses details and creates an atmosphere. The speech addresses its audience, argues with reasons and examples and ends with a clear call to action. Sentences are

varied and controlled, vocabulary is precise and sometimes ambitious, and errors are few and minor. Judge quality, not just length.

What to look for

- Typical features of Chinese-speaking learners (missing past tense -ed or plural -s, "a" and "the", "he" and "she" mixed, "very" for every intensifier) are normal stages of learning English. Score them under grammar, but read past them to judge content.
- Memorised phrases from textbooks or exam practice ("As we all know", "In a word", "Last but not least") are common: they show learning, but judge the writing on what the student does with them.
- Writing much weaker than speaking is common in students from oral-heavy English courses; writing much stronger than speaking is common in students taught mainly through grammar and textbook dialogues.

3.4 Speaking and sentence reading (the interview, 15 minutes)

The interview is 1:1. The questions and the speaking band descriptors are in the **Interviewer guide** (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`), and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`). It opens with the **Graded Sentence Reading Screen**: the rules, your copy of the sentences and the meaning questions, and the reading age table are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`; the student reads from `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; the results go on the **Reading front sheet**. For Year 8, **start at Level 7 (sentence 19)**, and follow the rules in the guide for going back, stopping, the meaning checks and fluency. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Then use the interview questions (school and learning, interests, friends and wellbeing, future plans and aspirations, values, an opinion question) and give the **speaking band** with the descriptors in the Interviewer guide, recording it on the Interview sheet.

Pace. Ask the questions at the pace in Section 2 (about 160 words a minute), the same for every candidate.

The Interviewer guide's opinion questions (homework, phones) do not overlap with the writing tasks above.

4. Maths (25 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths pages. There are three sections. Section A is calculation and algebra. Section B is word questions: read each one carefully and decide what to do. Section C is problems with pictures, tables and a map. You cannot use a calculator. Show your working in the boxes: you can get marks for your working. I can read any question to you. Just ask. You have 25 minutes."

Read any question aloud on request, as often as asked, and point to the picture. Follow the access rules (Section 2): mark **L** if a Chinese-speaking colleague gave a question once in Chinese, and **NT** if the student says they have not learnt the topic. **Section B is the evidence for the maths profile:** if you see a student stop at a word question, you may offer once, quietly, to read it aloud in English. Note on the grading sheet which word questions were read aloud and which were given in Chinese (L).

Marking. Accept any clear, correct method. A correct answer with no working scores full marks, except in questions 14 and 18, where the working is the answer. Accept equivalent answers (for example 1/4 for 0.25) unless the question asks for a form (index form in question 1, standard form in question 9). Where a method mark is shown, give it for a correct method with one arithmetic slip. **ft** (follow through): where a later step uses an earlier wrong answer correctly, give the later mark. Where units are printed on the paper, a missing unit does not lose a mark. Explanations must be in English; short phrases with numbers are enough.

Section A: Fluency (10 marks). Calculation and algebra, no context. Questions 1 to 4 are at the level expected on entry to Year 8; questions 5 to 9 are Year 8 content.

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	$2^3 \times 3^2 \times 5$	1	Any order. $2 \times 2 \times 2 \times 3 \times 3 \times 5$ (correct, but not in index form) scores 0: note it, because only the notation is missing. $2^3 \times 45$ or $8 \times 9 \times 5$ score 0 (not all prime).	Prime factorisation; index notation
2	a 12 · b 840	1 + 1	a: 6, 4, 3 or 2 are common factors but not the highest. b: 10 080 (84 × 120) is a common multiple but not the lowest.	HCF and LCM
3	37%, 3/8, 0.38, 2/5	1	All four in order. Equivalents are fine (0.37, 0.375, 0.38, 0.4). 3/8 placed after 0.38 means 3/8 was taken as 0.38, or the digits were compared without converting.	Fraction, decimal and percentage equivalence
4	$4x - 7$	1	$-7 + 4x$. $4x - 23$ means -2×-4 was taken as -8 (the commonest error). The expansion without simplifying ($6x - 15 - 2x + 8$) scores 0.	Expanding brackets and simplifying
5	$6x(2x - 3y)$	1	$6(2x^2 - 3xy)$, $3x(4x - 6y)$ and $2x(6x - 9y)$ are correct but not fully factorised: 0, note "partly".	Factorising (Year 8)
6	$x = 6$	1	$8x - 12 = 3x + 18$ seen and then a slip: 0 (one mark only), but note the method. $x = 1.8$ means only the first term in each bracket was multiplied ($8x - 3 = 3x + 6$).	Equations with brackets and the unknown on both sides (Year 8)
7	$x < 3$	1	$3 > x$. $x > 3$ means the inequality was not reversed after dividing by -3 (very common). $x = 3$, or 3 alone, scores 0.	Solving a linear inequality (Year 8)
8	y^7	1	y^2 means the powers in $(y^4)^3$ were added, not multiplied.	Index laws (Year 8)
9	1.2×10^9	1	12×10^8 and 1 200 000 000 have the right value but are not in standard form: 0, note it. 12×10^{15} means the powers were multiplied.	Standard form (Year 8 to 9: ceiling item)

Section B: Word questions (8 marks). Words only, no diagrams: the student must read the sentences and set up the maths. Any correct method earns full marks (an equation, a bar model, a reasoned trial); a correct equation earns the method mark.

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
10	80 (degrees)	2	**1 mark** for $4x + 20 = 180$, or $x = 40$ seen. $x = 40$ as the final answer scores 1 (solved but did not answer the question); 60 ($x + 20$) with $x = 40$ seen scores 1.	Angles in a triangle; forming and solving an equation
11	40	2	**1 mark** for a correct equation ($n + (n + 2) + (n + 4) = 114$, or $3n + 6 = 114$), or 36 or 38 seen, or $114 \div 3 = 38$. 39 (from 37, 38 and 39: consecutive numbers, not consecutive even numbers) scores 1.	Consecutive integers; forming an equation
12	¥96	2	**1 mark** for 12 seen (one part: $24 \div 2$), or Amir ¥36, or Sofia ¥60. 64 (¥24 taken as Amir's 3 parts) or 38.4 (¥24 taken as Sofia's share) score 0.	Ratio: using the difference between the parts
13	48 (cm²)	2	**1 mark** for $3w - 4 = w + 4$, or width 4, or length 12, or the square's side 8 seen. 64 (the square's area) or 32 (the rectangle's perimeter) with width 4 and length 12 seen score 1.	Forming and solving an equation with the unknown on both sides; area

Section C: Applied problems (12 marks). Multi-step problems in real contexts, with a diagram, table or map in every question. Question 18 (a garden sprinkler) is the unfamiliar context; questions 14, 17b and 18 ask the student to explain or show.

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
14	**No.** Shop A: 600 → 480 → ¥432. Shop B: ¥420. Shop B is ¥12 cheaper.	2	**1 mark** for 432 and 420 both seen, or one of them with a correct method for the other. **2 marks** for "No" (ticked or written) with both prices, or with an equivalent reason (0.8 × 0.9 = 0.72, so Shop A takes off 28%, not 30%). "No" with no working, or "Yes": 0. "Yes, both are 30% off" (adding the percentages) is the classic error: note it. If a student finds 20% of 600 = 120 and stops, the word "off" may be the barrier: read it aloud.	Percentage decrease; successive percentages; best value; explaining
15	a 0.25 · b 60	1 + 1	a: 1/4, 25%. 0.75 is red and blue together. b: 15 ÷ 0.25, or 15 × 4. ft 15 ÷ (their a) if it gives a whole number. 3.75 (15 × 0.25) scores 0. (The bag has 18 red, 27 blue and 15 green counters.)	Probabilities add up to 1; probability and frequency
16	9:58	3	**1 mark** for the real distance: 4.5 km (or 4500 m, or 450 000 cm) from 9 cm × 50 000. **1 mark** for the time: 18 minutes (or 0.3 hours), ft their distance ÷ 15. **1 mark** for the arrival time, ft 9:40 + their minutes. Accept 09:58, 9.58, 9:58 am. 45 km (450 000 cm taken as 45 km) gives 3 hours and 12:40: scores 2 (ft). One length only (for example 3 cm) loses the first mark; ft the rest. 0.3 hours taken as 30 minutes loses the second mark; 10:10 then earns the third.	Map scales; converting units; speed, distance and time
17	a 2.2 · b Jun did not use how many students read each number of books: he must multiply by the numbers of students and divide by 20, not 5.	2 + 1	a: **1 mark** for 44 seen (the total number of books), or for at least three correct products (1 × 5, 2 × 6, 3 × 5, 4 × 3); **2 marks** for 2.2. 44 as the final answer, or 8.8 (44 ÷ 5): 1. b: any clear statement that Jun ignored the numbers of students, or that there are 20 students, not 5, or that more students read 2 or 3 books than 0. "He added it wrong" or "the answer is 2.2" alone: 0.	Mean from a frequency table; explaining a mistake
18	Circle: 3.14 × 3 × 3 = 28.26 m². Lawn: 6 × 6 = 36 m². Three quarters of 36 = 27 m². 28.26 > 27, so more than three quarters of the lawn gets water.	2	**1 mark** for both areas: 28.26 (or 9π, or 28.3) and 36. **2 marks** for a correct comparison with a conclusion: 28.26 > 27; or 28.26 ÷ 36 = 0.785 (78.5%) > 75%; or the dry part is 7.74 m², less than a quarter (9 m²). Also accept 9π > 9 × 3 = 27, because π > 3. The circumference (18.84) or the diameter used as the radius (113.04): 0, note it.	Area of a circle in context; showing a result (unfamiliar context)

Totals and sub-scores: Fluency (Section A, questions 1 to 9) / 10 · **Word questions** (Section B, questions 10 to 13) / 8 · **Applied** (Section C, questions 14 to 18) / 12 · **Total** / 30.

Reading the profile. Work out each sub-score as a percentage and compare them. A gap of about 30 percentage points or more is worth noting.

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency high, word questions much lower	The English of the questions, not the maths, is the barrier.	Check: read one or two word questions aloud in English and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese (L). If the student then solves them, record on the grading sheet that the barrier is English. Plan support for the language of maths; do not place the student in a lower set for this reason alone.
Fluency and word questions high, applied much lower	The student calculates and sets up problems well but is less practised at multi-step problems, choosing a method and explaining.	Teaching in problem solving and explaining, not more content. Usually suits a high set.
All three high	A strong mathematician.	Note the ceiling items gained (5 to 9, 13, 14, 16 and 18) in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency low	Many Section A topics are taught in Grade 7 or 8 in China.	Check the NT notes below: a low fluency score that is mostly NT is very different from errors on taught topics (questions 2 and 3).

Band guide v2 (maths, / 30; provisional, for a harder paper): 0 to 10 **1** Below expected · 11 to 16 **2** Working towards · 17 to 22 **3** Expected · 23 to 30 **4** Greater depth, likely top set. (These are under 35%, 35 to 54%, 55 to 74% and 75% or more.) List NT questions, and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

May not have been taught. A Year 8 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed Grade 6 (PEP sequence; other textbooks differ a little, so ask the student). These topics are usually taught in Grade 7 (初一) or later, so the student **may not have been taught** them:

Questions	Topic	Usually taught in China
1	Index notation (powers); prime factorisation written as a product (primes and factors are Grade 5)	Powers: Grade 7. The factor tree is in some textbooks only
4	Expanding brackets and simplifying (letters for numbers is Grade 5)	Grade 7
5	Factorising	Grade 8
6, 13	Equations with brackets and the unknown on both sides (simple equations are Grade 5; question 13 can also be solved by reasoning)	Grade 7
7	Inequalities	Grade 7, second term
8	Index laws	Grade 7 or 8, depending on the textbook
9	Standard form	Grade 7 (large numbers); multiplying in standard form later
15	Probability as a number; probabilities add up to 1 (likelihood in words is Grade 5)	Grade 9
17	The mean from a frequency table (the mean is Grade 4)	Grade 8

Usually **familiar**: HCF and LCM (Grade 5); fractions, decimals and percentages (Grade 6); angles in a triangle (Grade 4); ratio (Grade 6); discounts and percentages of amounts (Grade 6; Chinese textbooks usually describe a discount as the fraction of the price paid, so 20% off is "pay eight tenths"); map scales (Grade 6); speed, distance and time (Grade 4); the area of a circle with π = 3.14 (Grade 6). Questions 10 to 12 need only Grade 5 equations or Grade 6 ratio: they test reading and setting up, not new content.

Not covered in this paper: simple interest, the circumference of a circle and the median and mode are not tested, because 30 marks cannot cover every topic.

What to look for

- **Fluency against word questions.** Questions 6 and 13 are a direct pair (the unknown on both sides, without and with words). A student who gets 6 but not 13, and then solves 13 when it is read aloud, has an English barrier, not a maths gap.
- **Explaining.** Students from Chinese schools often calculate quickly and accurately but write little working. In questions 14, 17b and 18 the explanation is part of the mark: short English with numbers is enough ("No. A is 432, B is 420."). If a student explains well aloud but writes nothing, note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet: it shows maths understanding and a writing barrier.
- **Words that can block a maths question:** "off" (14), "without looking" and "altogether" (15), "consecutive" (11, explained on the paper), "average speed" and "scale" (16), "three quarters" and "show that" (18). Note on the grading sheet any question that was solved after it was read aloud.
- A low score that is mostly Grade 7 and 8 number and algebra (1 and 4 to 9) or statistics and probability (15, 17) is very different from a low score on taught topics (2, 3, 10 to 12, 14, 16, 18). Say which in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science pages. There are 7 questions. Some topics may be new to you: that is fine, do what you can. I can read any question to you. You have 8 minutes." The same access rules as maths apply (L and NT). Spelling does not matter in science answers if the word is recognisable.

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	a A gas · B solid · C liquid · b It increases.	1 + 1	a: all three for the mark.	The particle model; energy and changes of state
2	A, B or D	1	The name instead of the letter (cell wall, chloroplast, vacuole). C (the nucleus) scores 0: both cells have one.	Animal and plant cells (the picture gives the comparison)
3	C 1 · A 2 · B 3	1	All three for the mark: dissolve, filter, evaporate. A, C, B (filter first) shows the student has not thought about the salt being dissolved.	Separating mixtures; a method in order (working scientifically)
4	a lemon juice · b toothpaste or soap	1 + 1	a: vinegar is an acid but not the strongest. b: pure water is neutral.	Acids, alkalis and the pH scale; reading a table
5	a It stays the same. · b 5 (m/s)	1 + 1	a: "it goes down" is a very common idea (that motion needs an unbalanced force). b: 2000 means distance × time.	Balanced forces; speed = distance ÷ time
6	B	1	C (the most waves) means the student confused loudness with pitch.	Sound as a wave
7	C	1	The anther. A (the stigma) receives pollen.	Reproduction in plants

Band guide (science, / 10; provisional): 0 to 3 **1** · 4 to 5 **2** · 6 to 8 **3** · 9 to 10 **4**.

May not have been taught. A Year 8 entrant has usually done **no secondary science**: in Chinese schools biology starts in Grade 7 (初一), physics in Grade 8 and chemistry in Grade 9. Primary science (科学) covers some of these ideas, but textbooks differ. So a Year 8 entrant **may not have been taught**: the particle model and energy in changes of state (Q1; states of matter are usually familiar from primary science), the parts of plant and animal cells (Q2; microscopes and cells are often met in Grade 6), acids, alkalis and pH (Q4; chemistry, Grade 9), balanced forces and calculating speed (Q5; physics, Grade 8), and sound shown as a wave (Q6; sound and vibration are Grade 4). Separating mixtures by filtering and evaporating (Q3) and the parts of a flower (Q7) are often taught in primary science. Read a low science score with these notes, and judge the student's scientific thinking from questions 2, 3, 4 and 5b.

Not covered in this paper: energy stores and transfers are tested only through heating and changes of state (Q1b), and light waves are not tested, because 10 marks cannot cover every Year 7 topic.

What to look for

- Questions 2, 3 and 4 can be answered from the picture or the table with careful reading and reasoning, even if the topic is new: a student who gets them is thinking scientifically.
- One-word answers are fine. Answers must be in English; an explanation in Chinese scores 0.

6. Recording the results

1. **Mark the student paper.** Every question has a mark box.
2. **Copy the totals onto the grading sheet** (`Y08_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). Record there too whether Part B of the listening was given, the maths sub-scores and profile (Section 4), the NT topics and L questions, the writing task chosen, any access arrangements and your comment.
3. **Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`): the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes.
4. **Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet** before the interview.
5. **After the interview, put together** the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days. The overall English band is the band most of the four skills sit in: name any skill that is two or more bands below the others.
6. **File the marked student paper with them** (or shred it under the school's policy).